

Top 3 NBA Betting Value Picks This Week

After scouring the upcoming NBA matchups, we've identified three bets that offer strong value across the spread, over/under, and moneyline markets. These selections are grounded in the latest team news – including key injuries and recent form – to exploit mispriced odds. Below we break down each bet and why a professional bettor would find value in it, with supporting data and context.

1. Pacers -5.5 vs. Bucks (Point Spread)

Bet: Indiana Pacers -5.5 point spread vs. Milwaukee Bucks (Game 1, Eastern 1st Round)

Odds: Pacers -5.5 (-112 odds at DraftKings) ([Pacers vs. Bucks Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)) ([Pacers vs. Bucks Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#))

The Pacers enter this series opener as 5.5-point home favorites for good reason – Milwaukee will be severely shorthanded. The Bucks have **lost both of their superstar players** to late-season health issues: **Damian Lillard is out due to a calf blood clot (deep vein thrombosis)** and will miss the start of the playoffs ([Bucks' Damian Lillard to Miss Start of 2025 NBA Playoffs amid Blood Clot Recovery](#)) ([Bucks' Damian Lillard to Miss Start of 2025 NBA Playoffs amid Blood Clot Recovery](#)), and **Giannis Antetokounmpo is nursing a calf strain** that kept him out of the final regular-season games and makes him very unlikely for Game 1 ([Bucks' Giannis Antetokounmpo gets final injury status update for Game 1 vs. Pacers](#)). Without Giannis and Dame, Milwaukee's offensive firepower and late-game shot creation drop off dramatically. It's no surprise Indiana – normally a lower seed – is favored by a healthy margin here.

The Pacers, meanwhile, are at full strength and playing on their home court, where they went 25–6 in moneyline terms during the regular season ([Pacers vs. Bucks Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)). Indiana's dynamic young backcourt led by Tyrese Haliburton (18.6 PPG, 9.2 APG) and a versatile frontcourt (Pascal Siakam, Myles Turner, etc.) gives them a balanced attack ([Pacers vs. Bucks Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)). Milwaukee's depth will be tested – recall that **without Antetokounmpo, the Bucks were just 4–5 this season** ([Giannis Antetokounmpo injury update: Bucks star out for Game 1 vs. Pacers, timetable uncertain - CBSSports.com](#)). Expect Indiana to push the pace and take advantage of Milwaukee's adjusted lineup. The Pacers also have motivation after Milwaukee eliminated them in last year's playoffs, so they won't take a depleted Bucks squad lightly. Laying 5.5 points is justified by the talent gap on the floor. **In essence, this line hasn't fully caught up to Milwaukee's injury woes, making Pacers -5.5 a top value play.** The Bucks might struggle to keep it close given they're missing 60+ points of star production and face a well-rested Pacers team on the road.

2. Clippers +2.5 (or Moneyline +120) vs. Nuggets

Bet: Los Angeles Clippers +2.5 point spread or Moneyline (+120) at Denver Nuggets (Game 1, Western 1st Round)

Odds: Clippers +2.5 (-112) / ML +120 at DraftKings ([NBA Betting Odds, Spreads & Lines | DraftKings Sportsbook](#)) ([Nuggets vs. Clippers Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#))

This 4-vs-5 matchup projects to be tight, and the underdog Clippers present strong value to cover – or even win outright – in Game 1. **Los Angeles closed the season red-hot**, going 9–1 straight up in its last 10 games (7–3 against the spread) ([Nuggets vs. Clippers Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)). Kawhi Leonard and Paul George (joined by James Harden after a midseason trade) finally had time to gel, and it shows: the Clippers boast a **top-5 defense (108.2 points allowed, 4th in NBA)** ([Nuggets vs. Clippers Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)) and were one of the best ATS teams this year (47–35 ATS) ([Nuggets vs. Clippers Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)). Their veteran roster is healthy and rested after clinching a playoff spot, and they've already proven they can win in Denver – Los Angeles split the regular season series 2–2 and comes in with confidence.

On the other side, Denver is the defending champion but showed some **vulnerabilities down the stretch**, especially on defense. The Nuggets allowed 116.9 points per game (ranked just 24th) ([Nuggets vs. Clippers Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)), by far the worst defensive mark of any remaining playoff team. They rely heavily on Nikola Jokic's brilliance (a near **29.6-point triple-double average** this year ([Nuggets vs. Clippers Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#))), but if the Clippers can even partially contain Jokic or force Denver's role players to beat them, this game could tilt in L.A.'s favor. Remember, **the Clippers excel as underdogs** – they went 18–12 ATS when getting +2.5 or more ([Nuggets vs. Clippers Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)). Meanwhile, Denver wasn't dominant against the spread at home and now faces an opponent with comparable star power and superior depth.

Given L.A.'s defensive tenacity and the momentum they carry, taking the **+2.5 points provides a cushion** in what should be a close contest. A savvy bettor might even sprinkle the **Clippers moneyline at +120**, as the game is close to a toss-up on paper. The altitude in Denver is a factor, but with a full week of rest and preparation, the Clippers' veterans should handle it. All told, the **market is slightly overvaluing the Nuggets based on last year's reputation, while undervaluing how dangerous this Clippers team is right now**. Grabbing L.A. as an underdog is a value play with a solid chance to cash.

3. Pistons +7 vs. Knicks (Point Spread)

Bet: Detroit Pistons +7 point spread at New York Knicks (Game 1, Eastern 1st Round)

Odds: Pistons +7 (-108) at DraftKings ([NBA Betting Odds, Spreads & Lines | DraftKings Sportsbook](#)) ([NBA Betting Odds, Spreads & Lines | DraftKings Sportsbook](#))

The young Pistons are being spotted 7 points in Game 1, a generous cushion in a matchup where they've historically held their own. **Detroit actually beat the Knicks 3 out of 4 times in the regular season, including two wins at Madison Square Garden** ([Detroit Pistons vs New York Knicks Game 1 Info Revealed](#)). That head-to-head success should give the underdog Pistons plenty of confidence. Detroit was one of the NBA's most improved teams this year – they leapt to 44–38 after winning just 14 games last season ([Detroit Pistons vs New York Knicks Game 1 Info Revealed](#)). Behind former No.1 pick Cade Cunningham and a cadre of talented youngsters (Jaden Ivey, Jalen Duren, etc.), the Pistons found a defensive identity and a fast-breaking offense under coach J.B. Bickerstaff. They won't be intimidated by the bright lights of MSG, as evidenced by those two road wins in New York.

Meanwhile, the Knicks, despite a strong 51–31 season, have a few factors that could make covering a 7-point spread tricky. New York overhauled its roster midseason – they acquired All-Star big man Karl-Anthony Towns and wing Mikal Bridges in major trades – and while that upped their talent, it also means roles and rotations are relatively new. There could be an **adjustment period in this first playoff game with the new core**. The Knicks are also coming off a bitter seven-game playoff exit last year ([Detroit Pistons vs New York Knicks Game 1 Info Revealed](#)), so the pressure is squarely on them as heavy favorites. Detroit, by contrast, is playing with “nothing to lose” freedom in its first postseason since 2019 ([Detroit Pistons vs New York Knicks Game 1 Info Revealed](#)).

Tactically, the Pistons can match the Knicks' size and physicality. Isaiah Stewart and Duren patrol the paint, and Detroit added wing defenders like OG Anunoby (acquired at the deadline, whose status is worth monitoring) to bother Julius Randle or Towns ([Knicks vs Pistons Injury Report: OG Anunoby, Cade Cunningham Status ...](#)). With Cunningham healthy and orchestrating the offense, Detroit can prevent the Knicks from going on big runs. **Seven points is a lot in what could be a grind-it-out game**, so taking the underdog to cover is wise. Even if New York ultimately wins, the Pistons have the defensive chops to keep it close. Given their season series success and the likelihood of some first-game rust for New York, **Detroit +7 represents strong value** – a bet on the Pistons to punch above their weight and at least hang within a few possessions at the Garden.

Each of these three bets balances probability and payout in the bettor's favor. We leveraged injury news, recent team performance, and matchup specifics to find where the odds makers left some wiggle room. Whether it's a short-handed favorite likely to falter, or an underrated underdog ready to surprise, these picks give you an edge backed by solid reasoning and data. As always, monitor any last-minute updates (especially injury reports) and bet responsibly. Good luck!

Sources: The odds and lines are sourced from DraftKings Sportsbook and Fox Sports as of April 16, 2025 ([Pacers vs. Bucks Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)) ([Nuggets vs. Clippers Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)). Key news and stats have been drawn from NBA reports and reputable analysts, including injury updates on **Damian Lillard's blood clot** ([Bucks' Damian Lillard to Miss Start of 2025 NBA Playoffs amid Blood Clot Recovery](#)), **Giannis Antetokounmpo's status** ([Bucks' Giannis Antetokounmpo gets final injury status update for Game 1 vs. Pacers](#)), team performance metrics ([Nuggets vs. Clippers Game 1 prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 19 | FOX Sports](#)) ([Magic vs. Hawks NBA Play-In prediction, how to watch, TV channel, odds - April 15 | FOX Sports](#)), and head-to-head results ([Detroit Pistons vs New York Knicks Game 1 Info Revealed](#)). Each factor has been carefully considered to identify these top value bets. Enjoy the games!